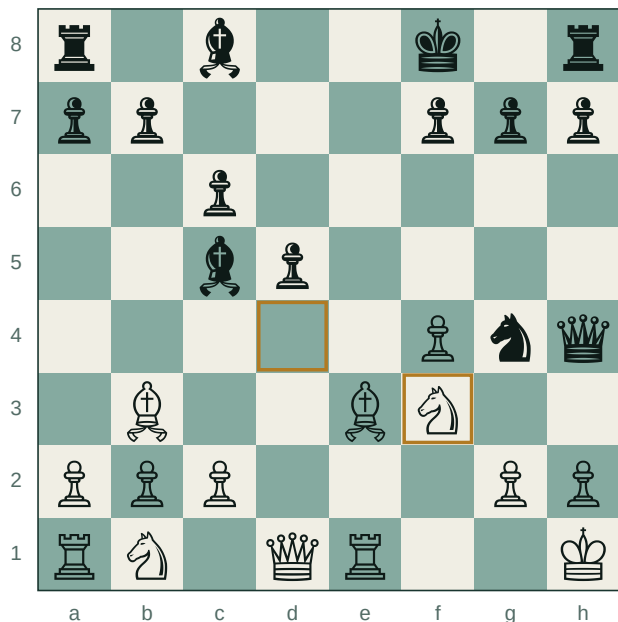


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 15

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Nf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Bxe3 16. Nxf2+ 17. Kg1 Nxd1+

15...Bxe3 The bishop captures the bishop on e3. Recorded reply: **16.Nxf2+**.

16...Nf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f2 it attacks king on h1 and queen on d1. Recorded reply: **17.Kg1**.

17...Nxd1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on e3 attacks the king on g1.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: pawn on h2.